PROFESSIONAL COMMUNICATION ETHICS SOP

Standard Operating Procedure — Workplace Tone, Response Cadence & Ethical Interaction

DOCUMENT OWNER	EFFECTIVE DATE	VERSION	CLASSIFICATION
HR & Operations	**October 2026**	**1.0**	**Company-Wide Policy**

1. POLICY PURPOSE & COMMUNICATION CHANNELS

Clear, respectful, and prompt communication is essential to maintain high operational standards, trust, and a positive team culture. This policy establishes expected standards across all official channels.

Channel	Primary Purpose	Target Response Time
Official Email	Formal external inquiries, client updates, official notices, and legal/contractual records.	Within 24 business hours
Internal Messaging (Slack/Teams)	Day-to-day team coordination, quick questions, operational updates, and urgent alerts.	Within 2–4 business hours
Telephone / Voice Calls	Urgent issues, sensitive discussions, or complex alignment requiring real-time resolution.	Immediate / Call back within 2 hrs
Scheduled Meetings	Strategic alignment, collaborative problem-solving, project kick-offs, and progress reviews.	Agenda shared 24 hrs prior

2. PROFESSIONAL TONE & COMMUNICATION ETIQUETTE

> **Core Philosophy:** Communicate with clarity, respect, and constructive intent. Professionalism means being direct without being defensive or dismissive.

- **Email Etiquette:** Use clear, descriptive subject lines (e.g., *"Action Required: Q4 Campaign Brief"*). Keep messages concise, proofread before sending, and use "Reply All" sparingly.
- **Instant Messaging Etiquette:** State your question clearly in a single message rather than sending fragmented greetings. Respect focused work time by setting status indicators when away or on deadline.
- **Meeting Etiquette:** Arrive on time, prepare required materials in advance, keep webcams on during remote client calls, and avoid interrupting speakers.
- **Appropriate Language:** Profanity, derogatory remarks, overly aggressive punctuation (e.g., ALL CAPS shouting), and discriminatory language are strictly prohibited across all platforms.

3. CONFIDENTIALITY & DATA PROTECTION

Employees are responsible for safeguarding company, client, and employee information shared in daily communications.

- Never share proprietary data, client financial details, or personal employee data in public or unencrypted messaging channels.
- Verify recipient email addresses carefully before attaching confidential attachments.

4. ANTI-HARASSMENT & RESPECTFUL INTERACTION STANDARDS

Our company maintains a strict zero-tolerance policy for harassment, bullying, or disrespectful communication in any form.

- **Respectful Conduct:** Treat colleagues, clients, and vendors with dignity regardless of role, background, or personal opinions.
- **Prohibited Behaviors:** Unwelcome personal comments, offensive jokes, intimidation, belittling feedback in public channels, and unwanted after-hours communication on non-urgent matters.

5. CONFLICT RESOLUTION, REPORTING & ESCALATION PATH

When professional disagreements arise, address them constructively through the structured escalation process detailed below:

Stage	Action Step	Responsible Lead
1. Direct Dialogue	Attempt a polite, private 1-on-1 conversation to address misunderstanding constructively.	Involved Employees
2. Manager Facilitation	If unresolved, invite the direct line manager to mediate a neutral discussion.	Line Manager / Team Lead
3. HR Escalation	Formal review for repeated misconduct, harassment, or severe communication breaches.	HR / Ethics Committee

6. DOCUMENTATION OF DECISIONS & COMMITMENTS

> **Verbal Agreement Standard:** Any decision, action item, deadline, or budget change agreed upon in verbal meetings or phone calls MUST be documented in writing within 24 hours.

- **Meeting Notes:** The meeting organizer must circulate a brief written summary (*Purpose, Key Decisions Made, Action Items & Owners*) to all attendees following any decision-making forum.
- **Project Tracking:** Update project management tools or shared repositories promptly so all stakeholders have full visibility into status updates.

7. POLICY ACKNOWLEDGMENT

I acknowledge that I have received, read, and agree to uphold the standards outlined in this Professional Communication Ethics SOP.

Employee Name: _____	**Manager / HR Rep:** _____
Signature: _____	**Signature:** _____
Date: _____	**Date Received:** _____